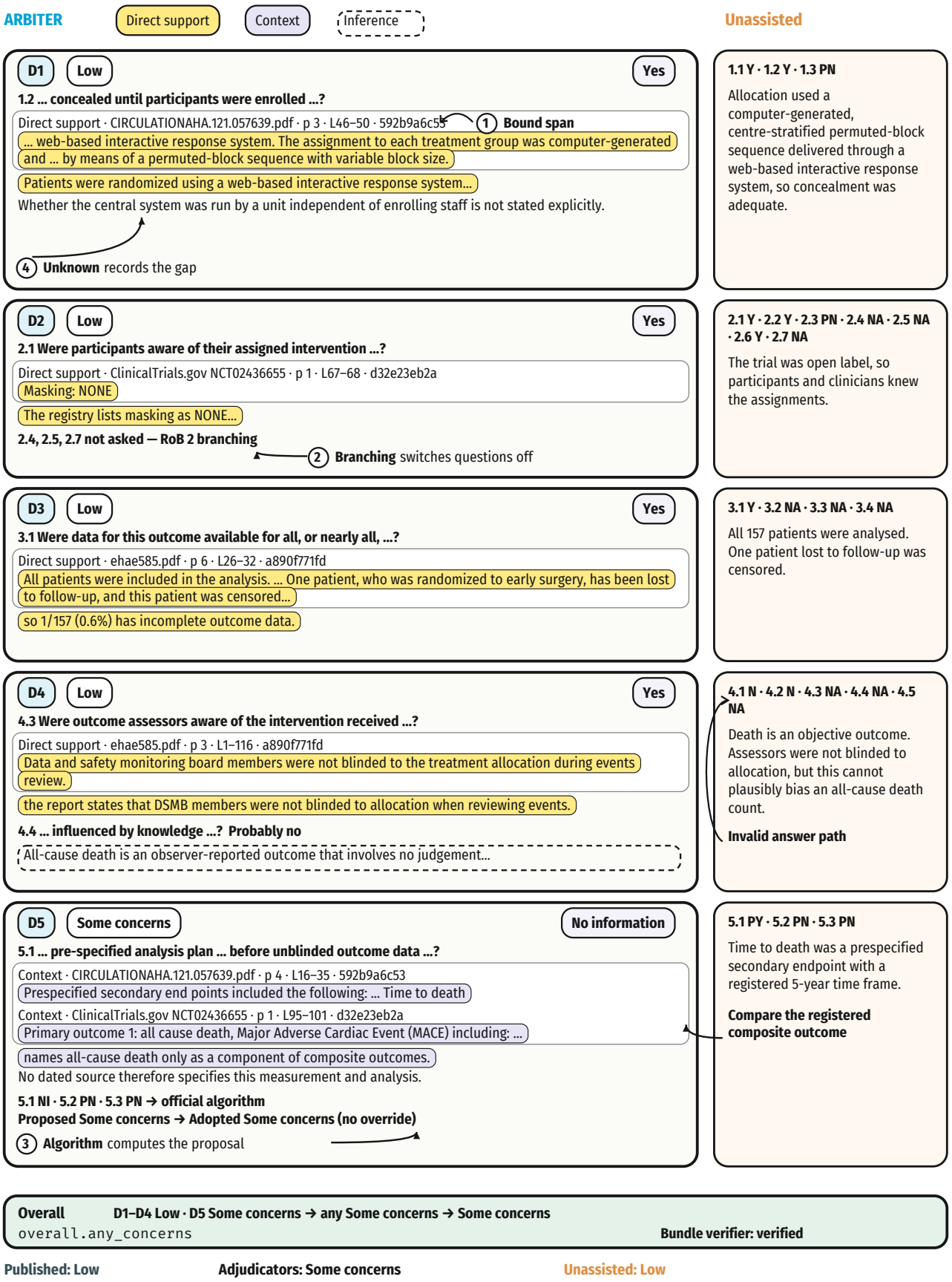
ARBITER
Direct support
Context
Inference
Unassisted
D1
Low
Yes
1.2 … concealed until participants were enrolled …?
Direct support · CIRCULATIONAHA.121.057639.pdf · p 3 · L46–50 · 592b9a6c53
1 Bound span
… web-based interactive response system. The assignment to each treatment group was computer-generated and … by means of a permuted-block sequence with variable block size.
Patients were randomized using a web-based interactive response system…
Whether the central system was run by a unit independent of enrolling staff is not stated explicitly.
4 Unknown records the gap
1.1 Y · 1.2 Y · 1.3 PN
Allocation used a computer-generated, centre-stratified permuted-block sequence delivered through a web-based interactive response system, so concealment was adequate.
D2
Low
Yes
2.1 Were participants aware of their assigned intervention …?
Direct support · ClinicalTrials.gov NCT02436655 · p 1 · L67–68 · d32e23eb2a
Masking: NONE
The registry lists masking as NONE…
2.4, 2.5, 2.7 not asked — RoB 2 branching
2 Branching switches questions off
2.1 Y · 2.2 Y · 2.3 PN · 2.4 NA · 2.5 NA · 2.6 Y · 2.7 NA
The trial was open label, so participants and clinicians knew the assignments.
D3
Low
Yes
3.1 Were data for this outcome available for all, or nearly all, …?
Direct support · ehae585.pdf · p 6 · L26–32 · a890f771fd
All patients were included in the analysis. … One patient, who was randomized to early surgery, has been lost to follow-up, and this patient was censored…
so 1/157 (0.6%) has incomplete outcome data.
3.1 Y · 3.2 NA · 3.3 NA · 3.4 NA
All 157 patients were analysed. One patient lost to follow-up was censored.
D4
Low
Yes
4.3 Were outcome assessors aware of the intervention received …?
Direct support · ehae585.pdf · p 3 · L1–116 · a890f771fd
Data and safety monitoring board members were not blinded to the treatment allocation during events review.
the report states that DSMB members were not blinded to allocation when reviewing events.
4.4 … influenced by knowledge …? Probably no
All-cause death is an observer-reported outcome that involves no judgement…
4.1 N · 4.2 N · 4.3 NA · 4.4 NA · 4.5 NA
Death is an objective outcome. Assessors were not blinded to allocation, but this cannot plausibly bias an all-cause death count.
Invalid answer path
D5
Some concerns
No information
5.1 … pre-specified analysis plan … before unblinded outcome data …?
Context · CIRCULATIONAHA.121.057639.pdf · p 4 · L16–35 · 592b9a6c53
Prespecified secondary end points included the following: … Time to death
Context · ClinicalTrials.gov NCT02436655 · p 1 · L95–101 · d32e23eb2a
Primary outcome 1: all cause death, Major Adverse Cardiac Event (MACE) including: …
names all-cause death only as a component of composite outcomes.
No dated source therefore specifies this measurement and analysis.
5.1 NI · 5.2 PN · 5.3 PN → official algorithm
Proposed Some concerns → Adopted Some concerns (no override)
3 Algorithm computes the proposal
5.1 PY · 5.2 PN · 5.3 PN
Time to death was a prespecified secondary endpoint with a registered 5-year time frame.
Compare the registered composite outcome
Overall
D1–D4 Low · D5 Some concerns → any Some concerns → Some concerns
overall.any_concerns
Bundle verifier: verified
Published: Low
Adjudicators: Some concerns
Unassisted: Low